



SET OF MATERIALS CONTEXTUALIZED FOR ESCAPE ROOM 1

**WP2. Identification and creation of contextualized
media literacy scenarios**



UNIVERSITY OF
EASTERN FINLAND



FUNDACIÓN
MALDITA.ES



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Title

Set of materials related to media literacy contextualized to each region for escape room 1 (D2.2)

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1. Introduction

The present document outlines the materials and examples of hoaxes selected for the implementation of Escape Room 1 as part of the ENDGAME project. The focus is on disinformation narratives and hoaxes related to food and health, contextualized for Spain, Finland and Serbia. The narratives and examples selected are among the most pressing ones in each country.

2. Materials and examples by country

SPAIN

Narratives in Spain related to health and nutrition share a common thread: they aim to undermine scientific knowledge, to foster distrust in health institutions and to promote unverified or pseudoscientific alternatives. Nutrition-related hoaxes—such as those linking additives or everyday foods to cancer, or promoting unproven “miracle” diets and detox practices as safer or more effective than conventional health guidance—have become especially widespread, especially among young people and often exploit fear and lack any scientific foundation. Other messages focus on discrediting medications or suggesting that pharmaceutical companies hide effective treatments, reinforcing a conspiratorial view of the healthcare system.

Disinformation about food regulation often targets public trust in institutions like the European Union by spreading false claims that EU food safety standards are secretly compromised. These narratives suggest that foreign powers or multinational corporations—often from countries outside the EU—are manipulating regulations to flood European markets with unsafe or genetically modified products, undermining local agriculture and public health. By framing EU decisions as opaque or influenced by external threats, such disinformation erodes confidence in democratic processes, portraying regulatory systems as tools of control rather than protection, and weakening citizens’ belief in their ability to influence policy through democratic means.

These narratives circulate primarily through messaging apps and social media platforms like WhatsApp and TikTok, often bypassing traditional media and fact-checking filters.

Example 1: EU Authorization of worms in food

There are reports circulating that the European Union (EU) has authorised the inclusion of worm larvae in food from February 2025, that ‘we are going to eat worms without

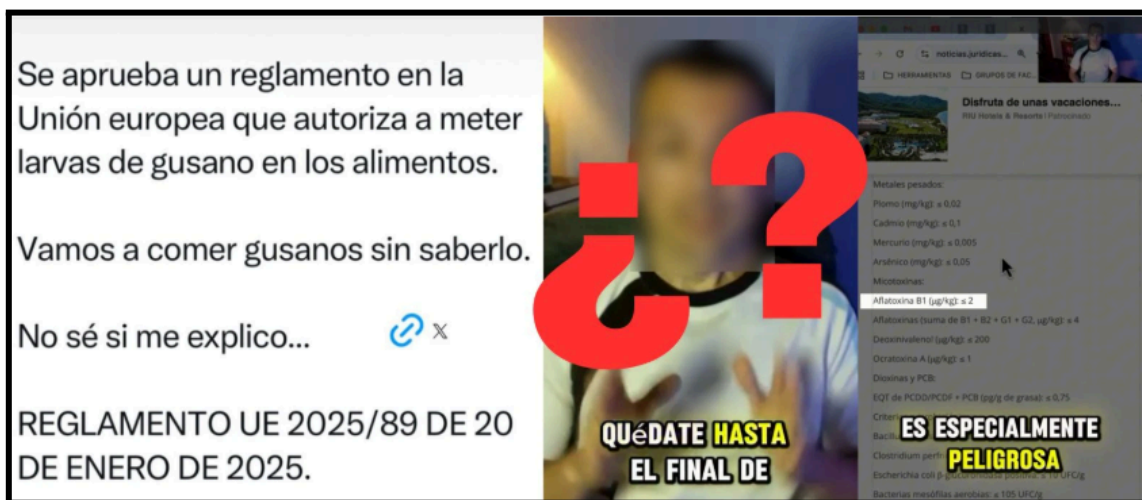


knowing it' and that it is a risk because it contains toxic elements such as mercury, arsenic and aflatoxin.

Whole insects and their parts are officially considered a novel food across the European Union since 2018 and four species are authorised for human consumption, including the mealworm. In January 2025, the French company Nutriearth's application to market UV-treated powder from whole mealworm larvae in the EU was approved. This treatment serves to disinfect and, according to the manufacturer, to increase the amount of vitamin D3. It is to be used in breads, cakes and pastries, cheese and other foods for the general population. Its presence must be stated on labels. The amounts of heavy metals and mycotoxins are below the maximum levels allowed in food.

Multimedia support:

- **European Regulation 2015/2283** regulating the use of insects in food: [Eur-lex.europa.eu](https://eur-lex.europa.eu)
- **News from the Spanish Agency for Food Safety and Nutrition** regarding the use of insects in food: Aesan.gob.es
- **Information note from the Spanish Agency for Food Safety and Nutrition** on insects allowed in food: Aesan.gob.es
- **Approval of the application of the company Nutriearth by the European Commission** to market treated mealworm powder: Eur-lex.europa.eu



Screenshot 1: examples of hoaxes in social media

Example 2: Imported Moroccan agricultural products won't have to go through health controls in Spain

Claims have circulated that Moroccan agricultural products entering Spain are exempt from health and safety controls due to bilateral agreements, raising fears about the

quality and safety of these imports. However, all food products entering the European Union from third countries are subject to border inspections.

Multimedia support:

- **Article about the Moroccan agricultural products:** [Maldita.es](https://maldita.es/)
- **Link to hoax online regarding the agricultural products:** [Twitter \(now X\)](https://twitter.com/)
- **The Ministerial Order of 2024** stipulates that the actions of the official border control services are the responsibility of the Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries and Food and its inspecting staff: [Boe.es](https://boe.es/)



Screenshot 2: example of website with false information

Example 3: Use of influencers to promote health products

Several influencers in Spain have promoted health-related products (such as anti-cellulite leggings or teeth whiteners) with exaggerated or false benefits, leading to deceptive advertising practices and consumer misinformation.

Some influencers use their public image and unsubstantiated claims to market health-related products to their followers. These endorsements are legally forbidden, lack transparency, and are misleading. In addition, social media advertising must be clearly labeled as paid content—hidden or vague tags aren't enough.

Multimedia support:

- **Article from Maldita:** [Maldita.es](https://maldita.es/)
- **FACUA's statement on deceptive influencer advertising:** [Facua.org](https://facua.org/)
- **Royal Decree on advertising and commercial promotion of products, activities or services with a purported health purpose:** [Boe.es](https://boe.es/)

- **Code of conduct** on the use of influencers in advertising: autocontrol.es



Screenshot 3: examples of influencers promoting health-related products

Example 4: Impersonation of “influencers” on social media

Scammers sometimes create fake profiles impersonating influencers on platforms like Instagram. These accounts use tactics like fake contests and prize giveaways to steal personal information or financial details from followers. Victims are often lured by promises of prizes or investment opportunities, unaware that real contests typically never ask for sensitive information.

Additionally, scammers have used influencer identities to promote fraudulent products, including unverified weight-loss supplements among others, falsely claiming endorsements from celebrities.

Multimedia support:

- **Article from Maldita:** [Maldita.es](https://maldita.es)
- **Example of scam and impersonation:** [Maldita.es](https://maldita.es)
- **Example of fake website** to promote fake health-related products: Website



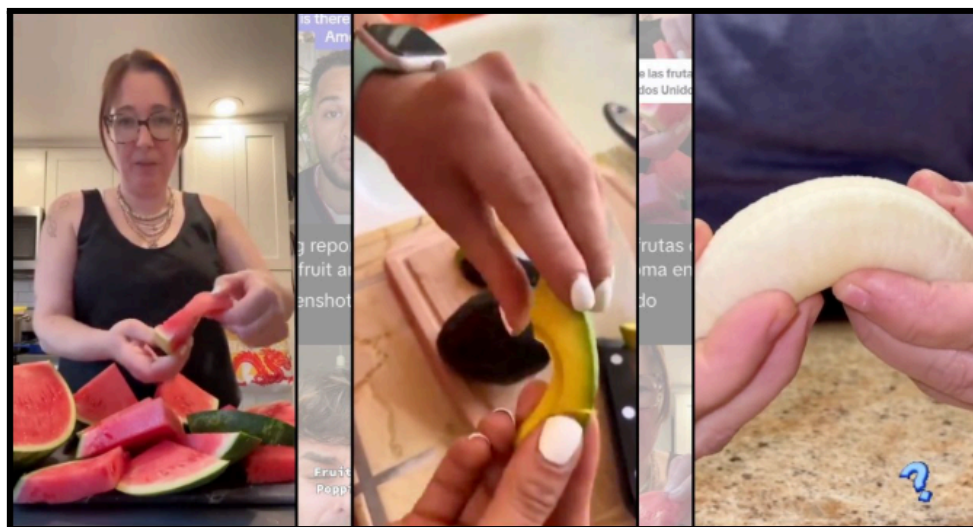
Screenshot 4: examples of impersonation of an influencer

Example 5: Claims of fake rubber like fruit

Viral videos have circulated claiming that fruits such as avocados and bananas are “fake,” “synthetic,” or made of rubber. These claims are based on the unusual textures observed in certain cases. Experts confirm that the rubbery texture can occur in under-ripe or improperly stored fruits. For instance, avocados and bananas when picked too early their firmness and texture may appear unusual but are entirely natural.

Multimedia support:

- **Article about rubber-like food:** [Maldita.es](https://www.maldita.es/)
- **Example of this narrative in social media:** [Twitter \(now X\)](https://twitter.com/)
- **Video explaining** the rubber-texture of avocados in TikTok by a food technologist: [TikTok](https://www.tiktok.com/)



Screenshot 5: examples of videos showing “fake” food

FINLAND

Disinformation in Finland related to health and nutrition is centered around lifestyle, diet, and appearance, particularly among younger demographics. Narratives promoting meat-based diets by influencers presenting them as offering miraculous results are gaining presence in opposition to plant-based or official dietary recommendations. These claims frequently rely on cherry-picked scientific data, personal testimonials, and vague accusations of bias within the scientific community.

Other recurring narratives include short-lived health trends promoted mainly by influencers, such as drinking raw milk, consuming apricot seeds for “vitamin B16,” or urine cleansing, often lacking any scientific foundation.

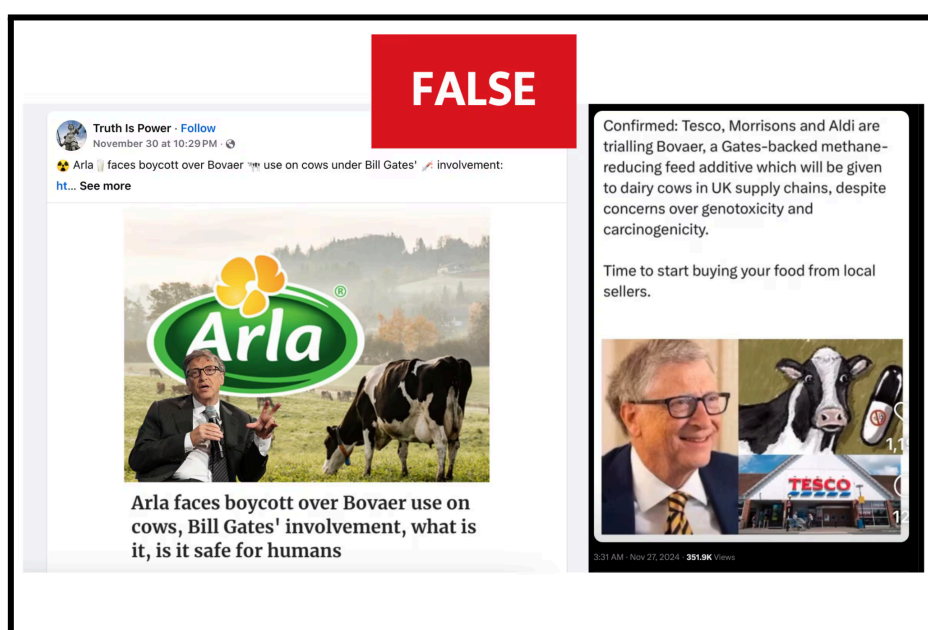
Example 1: False claims about Bovaer feed additive

Narratives circulating on social media claim that Bovaer — a bovine feed additive approved in the EU to reduce methane emissions — is dangerous for human health. These posts allege that the additive remains in meat and dairy products and poses health risks.

Scientific evidence shows that Bovaer is fully dissolved in the cow’s digestive system and does not transfer to humans.

Multimedia support:

- **Verified article:** [Faktabaari](#)
- **Communication from Valio dairy farms** on the use of the supplement: [Valio](#)
- **Article from the University of Finland:** [Helsinki.fi](#)



Screenshot 6: post with false content. Source: The Globe and Mail

Example 2: Saturated fats – not Omega-6 – increase the risk of cardiovascular diseases

Some viral content claims that Omega-6 fatty acids – present in seed oils – are harmful, and that they cause cardiovascular disease. Experts refute the claim, citing the scientific consensus that saturated fats (mostly from animal sources) are the main risk factor for heart and arterial disease. Omega-6, in balanced intake, is considered safe and even beneficial.

Multimedia support:

- **Article informing about this false claim:** [Faktantarkistus.afp](https://faktantarkistus.afp)
- **Study about Omega 6 from Harvard Medical School:** [Harvard](https://harvard.edu)



Screenshot 7: Facebook post making misleading claims

Example 3: Human activity is warming the planet dangerously fast

Narratives circulating on social media claim that the Earth is currently colder than it has been in hundreds of millions of years, implying that today's global warming is not significant or alarming.

Experts refute the claim as misleading, as despite the fact the average temperature is cooler than 100 million years ago, the rapidity of current global warming is unprecedented in human history. This speed of change poses a major risk to ecosystems, societies and economies.

Multimedia support:

- **Post informing about climate change:** [Faktantarkistus.afp](https://faktantarkistus.afp)

- **Post with false claim:** [Faktantarkistus.afp](https://factcheck.afp.com/32GX2YQ)
- **Article** informing about false claims about CO2 and climate models: <https://factcheck.afp.com/doc.afp.com.32GX2YQ>



Screenshot 7: Facebook post making misleading claims

Example 4: Effects of lowering cholesterol levels are being distorted in the social media

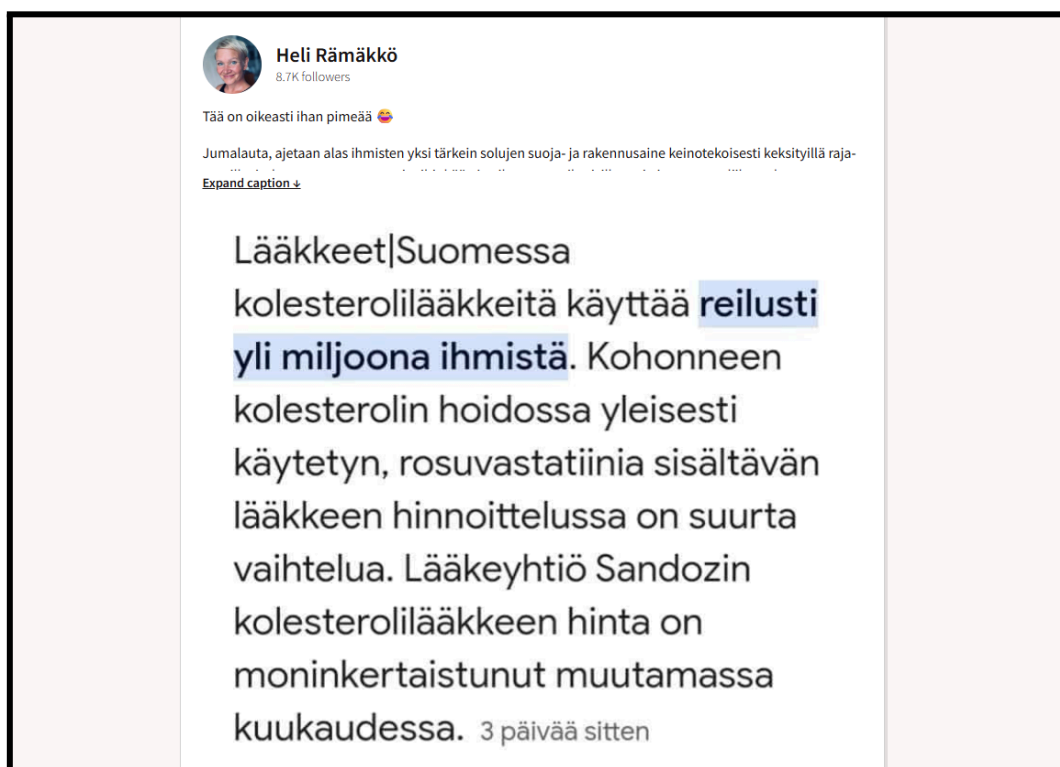
The safety of statin medication used to lower cholesterol is being questioned in social media and there are claims that high LDL cholesterol levels are not dangerous. These posts often suggest that the risks of statins outweigh the benefits and promote “natural” alternatives instead.

Experts refute these claims and emphasize that side effects of statins are rare and typically mild, while their effectiveness in reducing the risk of cardiovascular disease is

well documented. High LDL cholesterol remains a major risk factor, especially in populations with other health vulnerabilities.

Multimedia support:

- **Video with scientific update on cholesterol** target values and their relation to cardiovascular risk: [Youtube](#)
- **Article** informing about the risks of high cholesterol levels: [Faktantarkistus.afp](#)
- **Post** from the National Institutes of Health linking Alzheimer and cholesterol: [Nih.gov](#)



Screenshot 8: Facebook post making misleading claims

SERBIA

In Serbia, health and nutrition-related disinformation often draws on broader mistrust toward modern science and medical institutions. According to an investigation by the Fake News Tragač portal, which analysed false news stories between December 2017 and December 2021, several mechanisms are commonly used in medical disinformation campaigns in Serbia.

These include reporting non-existent studies, using flawed research methodologies, inaccurately reporting facts, and distorting or embellishing scientific findings. Many of these narratives reflect recurring themes displayed in Serbian media, such as the idea that modern society is in decline and that Western medicine is harmful and ineffective, often serving the interests of the pharmaceutical industry.

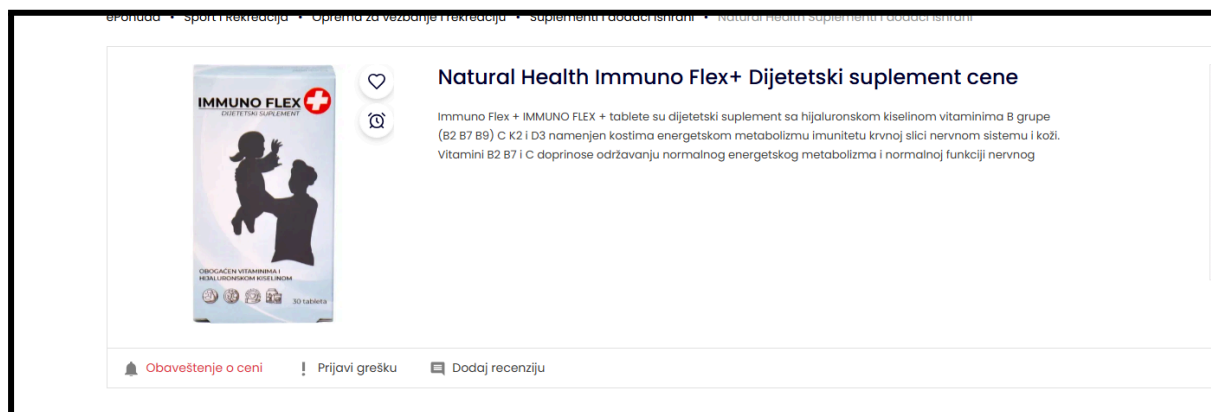
Example 1: Fake supplement ads promoted on Serbian websites

Several Serbian news portals have published deceptive advertisements for health supplements, claiming “80% discounts only today” and using fabricated testimonials from non-existent doctors such as “Dr. Mihaela Sander” and “Dr. Edvard Knut.” These ads falsely claim approval from health authorities and exploit urgency tactics like countdown timers and limited-time offers.

The products are advertised as miracle cures for joint pain, diabetes, and circulation problems, with fake reviews and logos of institutions to give credibility. Also, they impersonate real people to present them as doctors promoting the supplement or as fake satisfied customers.

Multimedia support:

- **Article from Raskrikavanje:** [Raslovanje.rs](https://raskrikavanje.rs/)
- **Supplement ads:** [Epona](https://epona.rs/)
- **Example of scam website:** <https://archive.ph/fbsVQ>



Screenshot 9: Website selling a fake supplement

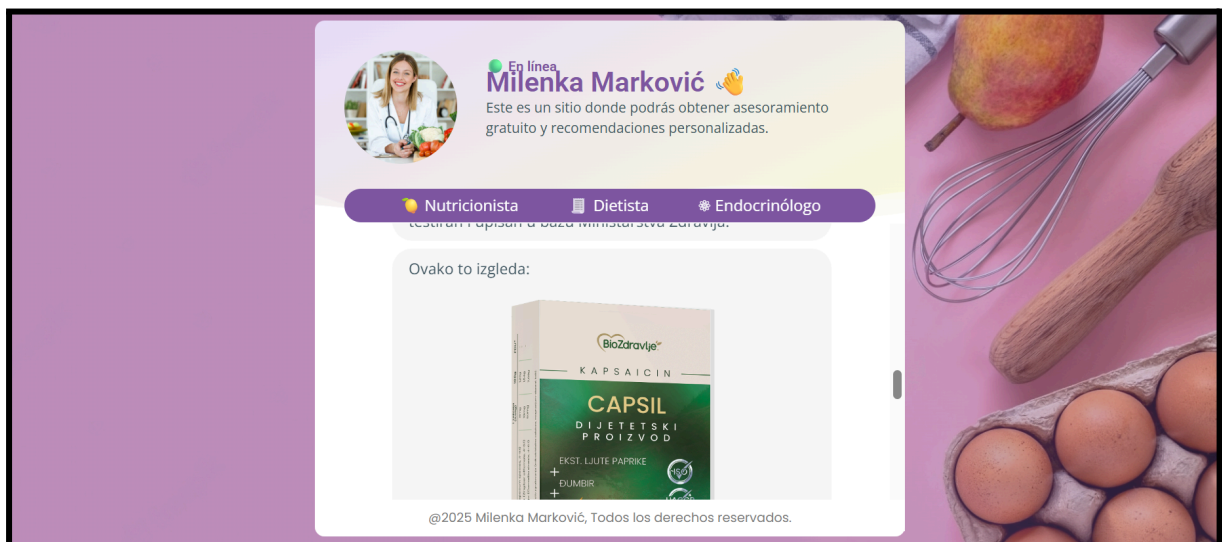
Example 2: Nonexistent doctor promotes fake weight-loss supplement

An online advertisement falsely attributes the promotion of a weight-loss supplement to a person identified as "Dr. Ivana Stević," presented as a medical expert from Belgrade. The ad claims users can lose 17 kilograms in one month using this product, which is described as a “natural formula” and a “miracle solution” for obesity.

Investigations confirm that the doctor does not exist, and the accompanying photos are stock images. The advertisement uses fabricated quotes, fake clinical claims, and logos of well-known media outlets to appear credible. It also includes a testimonial from a supposed patient who allegedly lost weight in record time, which is also fabricated.

Multimedia support:

- **Article from Raskrikavanje:** [Raslovanje.rs](https://raskrikavanje.rs/)
- **Chat to interact** with a fake doctor: [Buditezdravi.net](https://buditezdravi.net)
- **Website** selling a supplement for weight-loss with exaggerated effects: [Vitalon](https://vitalon.rs)



Screenshot 10: Screenshot from fake chat to sell a weight loss supplement

Example 3: Use of deepfake videos to promote unverified health treatments

A deepfake video circulating on Facebook falsely depicts Serbian doctor Branimir Nestorović promoting a treatment for prostatitis. The manipulated footage uses real video material altered with AI to make it appear as if the doctor is promoting the product in a misleading way.

These ads are run by pages based in Ukraine and the U.S. and are specifically targeted to vulnerable audiences, exploiting Nestorović's reputation as a medical expert to mislead them into trusting and purchasing unapproved products. There have been some other cases of manipulated videos using the Serbian doctor.

Multimedia support:

- **Article from FakeNews.rs:** [Fakenews.rs](https://fakenews.rs)
- **Original video of doctor Branimir:** [Youtube](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=...)

- **Facebook page that share these videos:** [Facebook](#)



Screenshot 11: Screenshot from AI-edited video

Example 4: False claims of the green frog logo on food packaging

There are several posts circulating in Serbian social media claiming that the green frog logo on food packaging indicates the presence of atrazine, a herbicide which allegedly causes hormone alterations and “male-to-female” changes in young men. The article debunks this narrative, explaining that the logo is merely a branding design, not an indicator of chemical content or risk.

There is no scientific evidence linking the frog symbol to atrazine use or suggesting that atrazine affects human hormone levels or gender identity. While some studies have examined the potential effects of atrazine exposure on animals, there is currently insufficient evidence to confirm similar impacts in humans.



Screenshot 12: Post on Facebook with false claims

Multimedia support:

- Article from FakeNews.rs: [Fakenews.rs](https://fakenews.rs/)
- Video from FakeNews.rs: [Fakenews youtube](https://fakenews.youtube)
- Study on the health effects of atrazine: [ATSDR](https://www.atsdr.com/hot-topics/pesticides/pesticide-atrazine/)
- Website with link: [Ghost Archive](https://ghostarchive.org/)

3. Recommendations for the escape room

The materials and examples presented in this document offer a diverse and relevant basis for the development of **Escape Room 1: "The Click Trap"**. This narrative-driven experience places players in the role of a janitor investigating a misleading influencer campaign from within a social media content agency called ConnectNow. The core theme revolves around **health, nutrition, and food supplements**, while secondary disinformation narratives (climate change, immigration, and politics) also appear.

The country-specific examples gathered—covering Spain, Finland, and Serbia—reflect real, verifiable disinformation cases that resonate with the escape room’s narrative. These materials can be added to the Escape Room through:

- **Screenshots or fake posts** displayed on desks or computers in the influencer agency.
- **Labels or packages** (e.g. for GlowUp+ or "worm-based" foods) that players can scan, compare, or cross-check using verification tools.
- **Emails or chat messages** found on devices, hinting at advertising deals, misinformation tactics, or influencer coordination.
- **Documents and regulations** (real or forged) that players must analyze to detect inconsistencies, manipulations or omitted facts.
- **Clips from social media** (TikToks, livestreams, "sponsored content") that embed misleading narratives players are challenged to debunk.

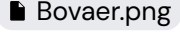
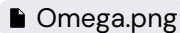
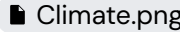
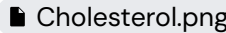
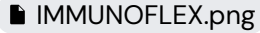
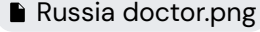
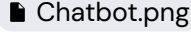
The **core learning objective** of the game is to show how unchecked financial motives and careless content creation can fuel the spread of misinformation. Also, the game aims to show how informed individuals can push back by verifying sources, asking questions, and sharing reliable information

The Escape Room also aims **to enable learners to identify and evaluate disinformation** related to food and nutrition, particularly as it appears on social media platforms. Additionally, it aims to **help learners understand how social media influences perceptions of health and nutrition**, including the role of influencers, algorithms, and viral trends.

Finally, we aim **to encourage learners to develop responsible information-sharing practices**, by fact-checking health content and thinking critically before engaging with or spreading it online.

Annex – Overview of Multimedia Materials by Country

Country	Linked example	Summary	Format	Language	Link / Source	File
Spain	EU Authorization of worms in food	Video debunking this hoax	Video	Spanish	https://www.tiktok.com/@malditobulo/video/7467985966372818199	
Spain	EU Authorization of worms in food	Video promoting this hoax	Video	Spanish	https://www.tiktok.com/@econature2020/video/7464890809838554390	 6797803e817b194059343487...
Spain	Moroccan agricultural imports avoid controls	Post promoting this hoax	Post in X	Spanish	https://archive.ph/YBcRr	 codigo marroqui.JPG
Spain	Influencers promoting health products			Spanish	https://maldita.es/timo/20221130/influencers-suplantacion-timos-falsos-concursos/	 influencers publicitan agencia...  influencers publicitan agencia...  influencers publicitan agencia...
Spain	Fake influencer profiles			Spanish	https://maldita.es/malditobulo/20210212/mensaje-privado-instagram-tirsa-garcia-phishing/	 maria pombo suplantacion.png  influencer marta suplantacion...  estafa influencer concurso.png  concurso fake.jpeg  concurso fake 2.png  perfil falso.png
Spain	Fake rubber-like fruit	Post with videos of “fake rubber like fruit”	Post in X	Spanish	https://x.com/CPJannyBarrera/status/1819237747418452423	 post fruta falsa.JPG  fruta falsa EU.mp4  platano.jpg
Spain	Fake rubber-like fruit explained	Video explaining the rubber-like fruit	Video	Spanish	https://www.tiktok.com/@soyrafacarbajal/video/7390948488911047941	 explicación fruta falsa.mp4

Finland	Bovaer feed additive health risks	Video promoting this hoax	Video	English	https://www.tiktok.com/@kehon.mielen.hyvinvointi/video/7465784139413720342?q=bovaer&t=1751274182884	
Finland	Omega-6 vs saturated fat	Post promoting a hoax about Omega-6 and health issues.	Facebook post	Finnish	https://www.facebook.com/permalink.php?story_fbid=pfbid02Tq9C65dzzvesxb9PYqSthK4SjJHGRXdLfph7VprpEir153yaSkFTfJe95vcHV73l&id=100070487787168	
Finland	Global warming is not dangerous	Post denying climate warming	Facebook post	Finnish	https://www.facebook.com/mika.kotikoski/posts/pfbid0gWCAGi4IVGqLSKJ4di2ytEBcMWkZhberD7UePX3qHhJY3rMLOzDBcU5yCtNkbUQol	
Finland	Statins and cholesterol myths	Post criticizing the link between high LDL-levels and heart disease, claiming LDL as healthy and important, and discouraging the use of statin medication.	Facebook post	Finnish	https://www.facebook.com/heli.ramakko/posts/pfbid02Y3t2eZ5dxTUcpdjRr7T5VboncekyqGEudXtV1MUwHW7ZuKBgh1G3d5bv2XvfCR5Jl	
Serbia	Fake supplement ads promoted on Serbian websites	Website promoting the supplement	Website	Serbian	https://archive.ph/fbsVQ#selection-1987.109-1987.120	
Serbia	Impersonate people for selling supplements without scientific-base	Website with the real profile of the doctor	Website	Russian	https://clinicamalyshevoy.ru/company/employees/rukovoditeli/malysheva_elena_vasilevna/	
Serbia	Website to have conversation with a fake doctor	Chat in a website to sell a weight-loss supplement	Chat	Serbian	https://buditezdravi.net/chat/	

Serbia	Deepfake videos	AI-edited videos using real footages	Video	Serbian	https://www.facebook.com/reel/1414466959238970	Deepfake doctor videos.png
Serbia	Deepfake videos	Facebook page sharing unverified health products and using AI-edited videos	Facebook page	Serbian	https://archive.ph/gcJzH	Deepfake FB account.png
Serbia	Deepfake videos	Use of a Serbian singer to promote preparations, allegedly intended for the treatment of osteoarthritis	Video posted in a Facebook page	Croatian	https://www.facebook.com/reel/768175701972689	Serbian singer.png
Serbia	A deepfake video	Falsely depicts Serbian doctor Branimir Nestorović promoting a treatment for prostatitis.	FaceBook	Serbian	https://fakenews.rs/wp-content/uploads/Nestorovic-1.mp4	Nestorovic-1.mp4